INLAND EMPIRE MEDICAL NETWORK, INC.
DERMATOLOGY AnhDao V. Le, M.D.

ALDARA Treatment

What is Aldara cream?

Aldara Cream is a **topical chemotherapy agent** (an immuno-modifier) that activates your immune system to flag the abnormal cells on your skin and recruits your own immune cells to fight and destroy these abnormal cells. **It will affect only abnormal skin areas**. This cream is FDA-approved for treatment of skin ~~diseases~~ conditions, including Actinic keratosis (A.K.; pre-cancers), superficial Basal cell carcinoma, in-situ squamous cell carcinoma, and certain warts. It may also help with minimizing hypertrophic scarring. ~~breaks~~

What will happen when you apply?

Within 1 to 3 weeks, the applied areas may respond if there are abnormal or photodamaged skin cells. It will not treat nor cause a reaction in normal skin or benign growths, unless that area contains abnormal cells. **A GOOD RESPONSE will include redness, burning, soreness, crusting, scabbing, swelling, and/or skin peeling.** Occasionally blisters or ulcers form with extensive diseased skin. ALWAYS keep the reacted sites covered with ointments, and may lightly cover with non-adherent gauze dressing if needed to protect clothings. When outside, use broad spectrum (UVA/ UVB) sunblock SPF30+ and protective clothings, and wide-brimmed hat and/or umbrella during Aldara treatment. Avoid or minimize sunexposure during the use of Aldara cream because it may heighten sunburn susceptibility and your side effects.

Results vary from person to person.

Instructions for proper application: (Do not follow the pharmacist's instructions !!)

- Apply at night time. After washing and dry the affected area, allow 10 minutes before applying cream
- Push the cream to the bottom of the foil packet.
- Use a small needle (safety pin) and poke a small hole into the top of the packet (near the dotted line).
- Squeeze a small amount of cream onto a Q-tip, or finger tip (must wash hands afterwards).
- Apply a very thin layer of cream to the abnormal areas instructed by the doctor:

  ☐ 4 nights on (MTWTh), 3 nights off (Wknds), for **a total of 6 weeks to cancers** (sBCC, SCC-I-S)

  On _____.

  ☐ 3 times a week (M - W - F) for **a total of 4 weeks to pre-cancers** (actinic keratosis)

  On _____.

  ☐ every night for **2 / 3 / 4 weeks to warts that were treated in the office**

  On _____.

- During the daytime, you may apply **Aquaphor ointment** (Vaseline white petrolatum) to the irritated areas to prevent infection and lessen discomfort. Moisturizer or sunscreen may be applied if not too irritating to the inflamed skin. When irritation is too much to tolerate, you may have a short break of 1 week … then **reapply the medicine for the complete cycle of treatment** !!

Please do not hesitate to call us at **909-581-6732**

1. If you believe you have an **allergic (itchy) reaction**, like hives.
2. **If your response is too extensive and too irritated to tolerate**.
3. If you have any other questions or concerns.

Remember to keep your follow up appointment in ___ weeks; on _____.